in these areas.[31] India responded with forward patrolling along its border,[32] and the heightened tension resulted in the Sino–Indian border war in the fall of 1962 that further advanced China's dominance in the region.[33]

Throughout the 1950s and 60s, the GDPs of China and India were approximately at the same level.[34] China, however, had higher military spending than India. China's military capital stock (weapons and structures) in 1960 was estimated to be USD 103 billion, in comparison to India's more modest 9 billion.[35] Nonetheless, the split with the Soviet Union in 1960 and growing tensions with India put China in a different position. In Mao's view, the Soviet Union's out-spoken neutrality on the Sino–Indian border dispute was in reality a message to Beijing that Moscow supported New Delhi. From the early 1960s onwards, Beijing faced two adversaries on its Western frontier, the Soviet Union and India. Mao was furthermore convinced that covert CIA operations into Tibetan areas took place with Indian support.[36]

It now became essential for China to counter Soviet expansion, in particular in Central Asia and South Asia, and to prevent India from dominating South Asia.[37] The combination of trying to consolidate its Western frontier, counter Soviet expansion, and hem in India, all at the same time, gave India a more prominent position in China's foreign policy. China approached this new situation by building an "all-weather friendship" with Pakistan and through supporting Maoist movements in South Asia.[38] By establishing a strategic partnership with Pakistan, starting with a border agreement in 1963, China was able to present India with a two-front threat. Beijing provided Pakistan with economic aid, weapon platforms, and support to build its military-industrial complex, as well as diplomatic and moral support during the Indo–Pakistani wars of 1965 and 1971. China's way of adding pressure on India through supporting